

YINING WU

University of Tennessee
Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics
Baker School of Public Policy and Public Affairs

ywu96@utk.edu
(+1) 614-906-1547
yiningwu510.github.io

EDUCATION

- **The Ohio State University** **2025**
Ph.D. Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics *University Fellowship recipient*
Committee: Brent Sohngen (Chair), Daniela Miteva, Seungki Lee, and Frank Lupi
Dissertation: "Ecosystem Services Under Threat and Opportunity: Recreational Fishing Losses from Water Quality Degradation and Carbon Sequestration Benefits of Crop Management"
- **The Ohio State University** **2022**
M.S. Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics
- **China Agricultural University** **2020**
B.S. (Hons.) Agricultural and Forestry Economics and Management *China*
- **Oklahoma State University** **2018**
Exchange Student (Hons.) Agriculture Economics

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

- **Post-Doctoral Research Associate** **June 2025–present**
University of Tennessee, Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics and Baker School of Public Policy and Public Affairs

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Environmental and Resource Economics, Land Use Economics, Coupled Human–Natural Systems, Applied Spatial Analysis, Applied Machine Learning, Non-market Valuation, and Choice Experiments

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Wu, Y., Sohngen, B. L., & Ludsin, S. A. "Who Stays, Who Leaves? Recreational Fishing Responses to Harmful Algal Blooms in Lake Erie," *Ecological Economics* 249, 109123 (2026)
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolecon.2026.109123>
- Stanley, P. L., et al. "Merging Rigor and Relevance in Grazingland Research: A Comprehensive Social-Ecological Monitoring Approach," *Carbon Balance and Management* 21(1), 67 (2026)
<https://doi.org/10.1186/s13021-026-00431-7>
- Wu, Y., Davis, E. C., & Sohngen, B. L. "Crop Rotation and the Impact on Soil Carbon in the US Corn Belt," *Carbon Balance and Management* 20(1), 6 (2025)
<https://doi.org/10.1186/s13021-025-00293-5>

WORKING PAPERS

- Wu, Y., Manning, D., Zhang, Y., Lupi, F., DeLay, N., & Bista, D. “Optimizing Grazing Management for Profit and Ecosystem Services: An Integrated Biogeochemical-Economic Model” (*Job Market Paper*)
<https://yiningwu510.github.io/files/wu-job-market-paper.pdf>
- Wu, Y., Lupi, F., & Sohngen, B. L. “Waters of Change: Estimating Spatiotemporal Welfare Losses from Recurring Harmful Algal Blooms in Lake Erie Recreational Fishing”

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Do Cow-Calf Producers Avoid Uncertain Conservation Payments? Measuring Risk Preferences for Ecosystem Service Contracts”
- “Optimal Conservation Portfolio Design under Uncertainty: Risk Sharing between Contract Providers and Cow-Calf Producers”
- “Siting and Powering Data Centers in Virginia and Tennessee”

BOOK CHAPTERS

- Wu, Y. (2018). “The Development of Rural Social Security System from 1978 to 2018.” In Li, J., et al. (Eds.), *Social Changes in Rural Area since 1978*. Beijing, China: China Agriculture Press, 393-404.

GRANTS

- “Data Centers and Housing Markets.” Office of Research, Innovation, and Economic Development, University of Tennessee. \$60,000 (FY 2027). PIs: Fitzgerald, T., Holladay, S., Leard, B., and Manning, D. Role: Key Personnel.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Instructor**
The Ohio State University
 - **Environmental & Natural Resource Economics (AEDECON 4310)** Summer 2024
Online Undergraduate Core Course (39 students)
Overall Student Evaluation: **4.44/5.0**
- **Lab Instructor**
The Ohio State University
 - **Introduction to Sustainability (ENR/AEDECON 2501)** Fall 2024
Undergraduate General Education Course (178 students total, 15-28 per lab)
Overall Student Evaluation: **4.38/5.0**
 - **Applied Econometrics II (AEDECON 7140)** Spring 2022
Ph.D. Core Course (7 students)
- **Teaching Assistant**
The Ohio State University
 - **Environmental & Natural Resource Economics (AEDECON 4310)** Spring 2024

- **Strategic Management** (AEDECON 4106)
- **International Economic Development** (AEDECON/PUBAFRS 4535)

Spring 2022
Fall 2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **Graduate Research Assistant** **2021–2024**
The Ohio State University *Prof. Brent Sohngen*
- **Project Leader** **2018–2020**
China Agricultural University *National Undergraduate Student Research Program*

PRESENTATIONS

- Southeast Energy Policy Forum. Knoxville, TN (August 2026)
- Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting. Kansas City, MO (July 2026)
- 3rd Annual Postdoc Research Symposium. Knoxville, TN (March 2026)
- W5133 Multi-State Project Annual Meeting. Boise, ID (February 2026)
- AREC Departmental Seminar. Knoxville, TN (October 2025)
- Camp Resources XXXI. Asheville, NC (August 2025)
- Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Summer Conference. Santa Ana Pueblo, NM (May 2025)
- Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting. New Orleans, LA (July 2024)
- Lake Erie - Inland Waters Annual Research Review. Columbus, OH (December 2023)
- Interdisciplinary Water Research Symposium. Columbus, OH (November 2023)
- Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting. Washington D.C. (July 2023)
- Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Summer Conference. Portland, ME (June 2023)
- U.S. Department of Agriculture Carbon Sinks Modelling Meeting. Atlanta, GA (September 2022)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Referee for *Carbon Balance and Management* and *Catena*
- Abstract reviewer for *Association of Environmental and Resource Economists* Summer Conference
- Proposal reviewer for CFAES Internal Grants Program

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- **Postdoc Travel Award** **2026**
University of Tennessee
- **AERE Graduate Student and Postdoc Travel Scholarship** **2025**
Association of Environmental and Resource Economists

- **Career Development Grant** **2023**
The Ohio State University
- **2nd Prize in Oral Presentation Student Competition** **2023**
Interdisciplinary Water Research Symposium
- **University Fellowship** **2020–2021**
The Ohio State University
- **University Distinguished Thesis Award** **2020**
China Agricultural University
- **Beijing Outstanding Student Award** **2020**
Beijing Municipal Education Commission
- **First Prize in Xiji-An Agricultural Economics Research** **2018**
China Agricultural University
- **President's Honor Roll** **2018**
Oklahoma State University

OTHER INFORMATION

- **Technical Skills:** Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face, scikit-learn, machine learning, deep learning, remote sensing, R, Stata, Matlab, HPC, ArcGIS, QGIS, LaTeX
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Chinese (native)